

www.orletonvillage.co.uk

ORLETON VILLAGE MAGAZINE



June 2026

How to be included in Orleton Village Magazine

This magazine will be published on the first day of each month on the Village Website:

www.orletonvillage.co.uk.

Notification of publication, together with a link, will be given on Nextdoor and Orleton Village Chat (Facebook)

Articles of general interest, club or association reports and advertisements for community events may be included without charge. Commercial advertisements are charged, dependent on size. (Rates available on request from:

orletonmagazine@gmail.com)

Small private sale advertisements may be accepted without charge if space allows

All content is accepted at the discretion of the editorial team. Articles that are disrespectful or prejudicial will not be accepted.

Copy should be submitted as Word or PDF files. If hard copy is submitted there may be a charge for scanning and input.

All copy must be accompanied by the name, address and telephone number of the author, although this will not be included unless incorporated into the article.

Articles for publication should be emailed to:

orletonmagazine@gmail.com by the 25th of the month prior to desired publication

Orleton Village Hall

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Editorial

This is still a very new magazine and we are still feeling our way.

We wish to promote village events by providing advance publicity.

We wish to show what people have been missing by publishing reports of events that have taken place.

We publish adverts from local business offering services to local people.

We accept FREE for sale notices from local residents

However, we wish to make this magazine entertaining as well as informative so a

new item this month is the short story section.

Each month we would hope to publish a short but entertaining short story, fact or fiction, or poetry, from a local resident. These can be published anonymously if the author is shy and retiring!

Suggestion for additional content are warmly received.

All notices of events, reports, adverts - paid and unpaid, stories and suggestions to Orletonmagazine@gmail.com

Copy date is 25th of preceding month but earlier submission is appreciated.



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Table Top Sale 14th June **(see advert for further details)**

Crafts, Produce, Bric-a-brac and much more

You can buy – Admission is FREE
You can sell – Tables only £10

Contact: bookings@orletonvillage.co.uk

Orleton Evergreens



Our 2026 programme is well under way:

The next few months see us out and about:

June 25th Seaside Outing to Weston Super Mare £20 (£22 non-members)

July 30th Outing to St Fagan's Museum of History, Cardiff £26 (£28 non-members), maximum 30 people

August 27th Outing to Gloucestershire & Warwickshire Steam Railway, Cheltenham £37 (£39 non-members)

ALL WELCOME

Further details:

sue.a.turner@gmail.com 01584
831324

A decorative rectangular border made of a light brown vine, adorned with various colorful flowers in shades of pink, purple, yellow, and red, along with green leaves. The border frames the central text.

Flower Festival

St George's Church, Orleton

Saturday 6 & Sunday 7 June

11am-5pm

**Beautiful & imaginative flower displays
celebrating 100 years of TV**

**Refreshments available,
including light lunch**

Coffee Morning

Every Wednesday – Orleton Village Hall 10.30 – 12.00*

Pop along, meet your friends & make new ones too. Parents and Grandparents are welcome to join us, with toddlers. We have a small selection of toys for them to play with.

We have a good choice of freshly-baked homemade goodies including gluten & dairy free, all slices are currently only £1 each. Beverages including Fairtrade are £1 for a cuppa with a free refill.

***Please note that we do not open throughout August, and we have two weeks off during the Christmas holidays.**



- Visiting Library – last Wednesday of the month
- A relaxed informal group with no membership fees
- Foodbank box for local foodbank
- We make charitable donations to local groups



Are you a local group who would like to run a fundraising coffee morning? Please Contact our Chair Cathy Hardwick via email at cathy.hardwick@hotmail.co.uk

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Orleton Art Group

Are you artistic or do you fancy trying your hand at painting and drawing? If so come and join us. We meet Wednesday afternoons from 2.00 until 4.30pm at Yarpole Village Hall.

For more information, please email Larry Turner, laurencepturner@gmail.com or Geoff Trotter, geoffrey.a.trotter@gmail.com

Or telephone Larry on 01584 831324



Community Safety

Please find below some helpful way to protect the information kept on your phone. Securing your phone in case it's lost or stolen.

If your phone is not well protected and it gets stolen or lost, thieves could access your banking apps, get into personal accounts, and even steal your identity. Consider whether apps containing sensitive personal information, such as banking apps, need to be on your phone at all. Some may be better kept on a tablet or other device that you don't routinely carry with you.

Use your phone's locking feature

Choose a strong PIN, passcode, password, or pattern, or use biometric authentication, such as Face ID or Fingerprint. Passwords are harder to 'shoulder-surf' than short PIN codes. You can also hide applications in secure or safe folders. This allows the folder to be locked with a different passcode to the device itself. Further guidance on

how to do this can be found on your phone manufacturer's help pages.

Get your IMEI number

Your phone's IMEI (International Mobile Equipment Identity) number can help identify your phone if it's lost or stolen. You can get the IMEI number by typing *#06# on your phone keypad. Keep a note of it somewhere other than on your phone.

Keep your software regularly updated. This will make sure both your device and apps have the latest security settings. You can set your phone to auto update in the settings menu.

Leominster safer neighbourhood team.

PCSO Stephanie Harper 6440
Police Community Support Officer
SNT Leominster | West Mercia Police
Enterprise Way, Leominster,
Herefordshire, HR6 0LZ
Mobile: 07773043483 Direct
Dial: 01432 347217 Ext. 7723019

Orleton WI

At our May meeting Orleton WI welcomed Andreea and her lovely family from Small Bakery a new artisan bakery in Orleton.

Andreea brought along an amazing display of baked goods. Various flavours of focaccia bread - olive, truffle mushroom, tomato, and rosemary and sea salt, fluffy English muffins, brioche bread, and sweet brioche pastries with raspberry and blackberry, hot cross buns and assorted sugary doughnuts.

The wonderful smell that greeted us in the village hall was very inviting.

Andreea then told us the story of how Small Bakery came to be.

Having recently moved to the countryside from London and following the birth of her baby, she did not feel ready to return to work and wanted to use her creative skills to do something she enjoyed.

Remembering the time she lived and worked in Italy, their passion for food and tasting many different dishes, Andreea set about recreating the focaccia bread she had eaten, experimenting with different techniques until she had perfected her recipe.

She had the idea to bake and sell her bread, set about building a small wooden house to display her baked goods and painted it pink. Thinking it looked like a little bakery the name Small Bakery was decided.

Orleton WI members were then given samples to try, the delicious breads enhanced by dipping in olive oil and balsamic vinegar. We then had the opportunity to buy some to take home.

Our thanks go to Andreea for telling us her story and baking so many delicious things.



At our next meeting on Monday 8th June our speaker will be Sue Moss from Ludlow Community First Responders and include CPR/DEFIB training.

The meeting will be at 7.30 p.m. in Orleton Village Hall.

Visitors welcome £5 including refreshments.

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SO YOU SAY
CARRYING A HEAVY CAKE
TO THE TABLE WORKS
ON YOUR ABS AND
CORE STRENGTH?

YES...AND
REPEATEDLY
LIFTING A SLICE
TO YOUR MOUTH
TONES UP
BINGO
WINGS

Orleton Coffee Morning needs you!

Orleton holds a weekly coffee morning at our village hall
on a **Wednesday morning at 10.30am–12 noon.**

We offer homemade bakes, hot drinks, and a friendly
informal place to meet and chat.

We would love to welcome a few more folk onto our
team of helpers.

*Do you have a favourite bake you may like to share with
us?*

*Enjoy meeting and greeting folk, and maybe you would
like to help at a session on an occasional basis?*

WE WOULD LOVE TO HEAR FROM YOU!

*Please contact our Chair Cathy Hardwick via email at:
cathy.hardwick@hotmail.co.uk*

Orleton Craft Group



We meet on the first and third Thursday afternoons in Orleton Village Small Hall, £4 per session.

Our Crafternoons run from 1:30 to 4:30, bring along whatever you are working on, enjoy friendship, chat, tea and cake!

Orleton Village **SUMMER FETE** **SUNDAY 5th JULY** **SAVE THE DATE**

Can you help us?

We need Volunteers to run stalls
and manage parking
email: orletonhandmade@gmail.com

And donations of second hand goods (no clothing)



Tales From The Potting Shed

On 28th April we welcomed Nicola Hope, a horticulturist, garden designer and writer. Nicola began her gardening career as a teenager doing work experience at Highgrove in the ornamental garden where she discovered a talent for topiary.

She worked at Highgrove intermittently while studying Fine Art at Cardiff and after attaining an HND in organic gardening at Pershore was offered the post of Head of Cottage Garden.

Nicola later moved to work at Lake House, owned by Sting, where under the aegis of the head gardener she learned a great deal about vegetable production and presentation. Lake House possesses Soil Association accreditation.

From here she moved to Abbey House, a fifteenth century house with five acres of gardens with the emphasis on colour in spring summer and autumn.

After a year she left to work at Cole Park, a private garden whose owner has an aversion to colour. Emphasis here is on symmetry, texture and the creation of vistas. Here Nicola learnt the value of structure, so important in winter. Symmetry and precision extended to the vegetable garden producing a calming atmosphere.

After four years Nicola went freelance and has been self-employed for sixteen years. Hers was a steep learning curve, having been the beneficiary of extremely knowledgeable head gardeners she was

now on her own. She had to solve problems herself and learn to delegate and now heads a team of gardeners.

Somehow, she found time to study for a Masters in horticulture and a professional diploma in garden design. She gardens organically and particularly enjoys growing heritage vegetables.

It was fascinating to hear how Nicola's chronological experiences have informed and influenced her working life from the colour of Highgrove to the symmetry and structure of Cole Park. From these and an artistic eye her own style has evolved.

Ghislaine Arundale

On Tuesday 30th JUNE

Alun & Jill Whitehead will present a talk entitled Hidden Gardens of Herefordshire introducing us to some beautiful gardens on our doorstep.

At Orleton Village Hall. Doors open 7.15pm for 8pm start. Non-members welcome at £2.50 per person

which includes tea or coffee. Annual Membership £15.00

www.orletongardeningclub.co.uk.

www.orletongardeningclub.co.uk

TABLE TOP SALE!

at Orleton Village Hall, SY8 4HW

Sunday, June 14th, 2026

10.00am - 1.00pm



£10 per table,
Maximum 2 tables per booking

Contact: bookings@orletonvillage.co.uk

★ ★ ★ or 01568 780583 ★ ★ ★

Orleton Parish Council

Presentation of the Highway Flood Alleviation Scheme

On 24 April the Parish Council was joined by Jacob Loughran of the Severn Rivers Trust and Ward Cllr Dan Hurcomb for the public presentation of a scheme of works to mitigate flooding on the B4361. This flooding also affects the village and surrounding area and has had a significant effect on the local economy. Ward Cllr Hurcomb expressed confidence that work to improve highway drainage capacity and redirect this around the village will be delivered in this financial year, with work to remove the choke above the B4361 commencing in September, subject to further negotiations with the landowner. Jacob was able to set out proposals for attenuation ponds on farmland above the B4361 to capture flood water before it reaches the village. This work will also begin in September.

This project has been in development since 2024 and would not have been possible without the considerable effort of Ward Cllr Hurcomb at the county level, supported by Cllr David Lane and Cllr Mark Wetton at a local level. The audience expressed its appreciation with a round of applause.

Following this meeting Cllr Lane stepped down from the Parish Council for family reasons, but he will continue to volunteer as a Flood Warden and to work with the Land Drainage Volunteers.

A New Chair and Vice Chair

At an extraordinary meeting of the Parish Council held on 6 May, Cllr Mark Simmons was elected Chairman and Cllr Colin Mitchell was elected Vice Chairman.

Parish Meeting

In a change to the previously announced programme, the guest speaker at the Annual Parish Meeting was Adam Breakwell, headteacher at Orleton Primary School. Mr Breakwell explained that Orleton is single-form entry with approximately 180 students, 100 to 110 of whom live in the catchment. The school places great importance on being part of the community and is very grateful to the numerous community members who volunteer at the

school. In addition to academic subjects, the school also provides every child with lessons in art—this year the children are learning about portraiture—and oracy, a project that has been supported with a grant from the Parish Council. The school also works very closely with Orleton Pre-School, from which comes most of each year's Reception Class intake. Mr Breakwell ended his talk by answering questions from those in attendance about the challenges to find funding for enough support staff, upcoming changes to Special Education Needs funding, and the counselling service available at the school.

The Chairman then gave a statement reflecting on matters that arose within the Parish during the previous 12 months. A copy has been included in the magazine and on the Parish Council's website.

The meeting ended with an opportunity for members of the public to raise issues for consideration by the Parish Council. A resident asked when the speed indicator devices (SIDs) would be in place. Ward Cllr Dan Hurcomb, who was in attendance, explained that the installation of the SIDs could not be completed until a new Section 106 Delivery Officer is hired by Herefordshire Council, but that the project has not been abandoned. Ward Cllr Hurcomb also told those in attendance that Herefordshire Council is reviewing the boundaries that determine which secondary school is closest for the provision of free bus transport to those families who live in the Bircher Ward.

Next Meeting

The next meeting of Parish Council will be on Thursday, 18 June in Orleton Village Hall at 6pm. Members of the public are encouraged to attend.

To contact the Clerk or any of your Parish Councillors, please e-mail clerk@orleton-pc.gov.uk

Stacy Perry, Clerk, Orleton Parish Council – 15 May 2026

Orleton Parish Council Annual Report, 2025-2026

I would like to begin by thanking the many volunteers in our parish who help and support in many ways. I won't thank people individually because it would be a very long list and I might inadvertently forget someone, but I do want to pay tribute to the trustees of the Rec Association, Village Hall and St George's, to the Good Neighbour Scheme, Caring for God's Acre, to those who organise the Coffee Mornings, to the Orleton History Group and relatively new St George's Community Association, to our land drainage and footpath maintenance volunteers, to our footpath and tree officers, to those who support our young people in various ways whether through sport, music, or community engagement, to those who serve and have served on the Parish Council, including Mike Tipping and Mark Wetton who have joined us recently, and Colin Mitchell who has rejoined after a brief hiatus – and who thankfully to avoid any further confusion is not called Mike or Mark! Thank you too to all those who volunteer under the radar simply by visiting neighbours or quietly but diligently helping in various ways by donating your time and treasures. You make our parish more welcoming, more connected and more functional.

I am also grateful to those who run and support our local businesses and help our village to be a place which thrives, and to our ward councillor Dan Hurcomb, who remains steadfast in ensuring that our interests and concerns are heard, even if resource constraints and competing priorities mean that it is not always possible for everything to be addressed as we may hope. The news in the last week has again highlighted how fragile political careers can be, and yet at the local level, parish and ward councillors – who often balance their responsibilities with professional careers – go above and beyond to ensure that communities such as ours are represented. My brief report is not a comprehensive review of all that has been done in the last

year, but a snapshot and an opportunity to say thank you.

We began this last year with a bad smell and a new clerk – which were in no way related! – and swiftly moved on to commemorate the 80th anniversary of VE Day, which – dare I say it – some of us can remember! Thank you to those who spent hours hanging bunting both for this event and the more recent St George's Festival weekend. Some of you will know that I am not a big fan of flags, not least given that they have recently been misappropriated by some people to convey a negative message, but I remain appreciative of the community cohesion and pride which can result from these occasions. It seems to me that this has been the case in Orleton. We now have a new clerk, and I'm personally grateful to Stacy, who brings her local connections and responsibilities as well as her previous service as a parish councillor to the role.

Attempts to improve flood management have continued through the year, including on the B4361 near The Maidenhead and retention upstream of that choke point. We appreciated the excellent presentation recently about these plans by Jacob Loughran from the Severn Rivers Trust, and others, and are grateful for what is already being done with local landowners. The main road through the village was also resurfaced in 2025, thanks to sustained advocacy by some councillors and our ward councillor.

We awarded grants to Orleton Primary School, the Village Hall and St George's, and – thanks to Martin Bradford and his team – more stiles and road signs quietly started appearing. They may not all have the apostrophes I crave – is Kings' Road named in honour of one king or many?! – but they all look lovely and in keeping. We of course kept close watch on our budget, and agreed a precept increase below the

Orleton Parish Council Annual Report, 2025-2026 continued

level of inflation, which unfortunately many other councils have not been able to do.

At last year's annual meeting we heard from Graham Shaw, David Lane, and Dan Hurcomb. I'd like to congratulate each of them on the progress that's been made over the last year. We have a functional pavilion and a workable plan to reduce flooding, we celebrate the dedicated and hard-working groups of volunteers, whether on land drainage, public rights of way or community cohesion, and we appreciate a ward councillor who has our back. There have been some ups and downs over the year, and speaking personally, I'm not convinced that our approaches have always been the right ones. Indeed, some

challenges remain – which, as a political leader recently said, I won't sugar-coat – and it can feel at times that clearer communications and calmer relationships would help our village and its various groups to work together even better.

However, none of that detracts from our sincere thanks to each of these individuals and to each of you for their and your efforts to continue to support our parish and to leave it in a stronger position than the one in which you found it. Thank you again.

Mark Simmons, Chairperson, Orleton Parish Council
13 May 2026

A Midsummer Evening with the Mighty Voices of the

Ludlow Male Voice Choir

St George's Church, Orleton

Friday June 12th, 7.00pm

Tickets **£12.50** available from;
Orleton Village Shop, Orleton, Ludlow SY8 4HN
Bensons Jewellers, The Buttercross, Ludlow.
Mark Wiggin Estate Agents, 50 Bull Ring, Ludlow.



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 **Orleton and District Gardening Club**

Hidden gardens of Herefordshire



copyright Sabine Rübe

A talk by

Alun and Jill Whitehead

Tuesday 30th June 7.30pm for 8pm start
Orleton Village Hall

Non-members welcome at £2.50 per person
Complimentary tea/coffee and biscuits

Membership just £15.00 per year
Come along to the meeting or see www.orletongardeningclub.co.uk

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Functional Movement Classes for:

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- improved posture.

Ella will take you through a series of functional-movement exercises always with joy, whilst encouraging ease and presence, to move you towards a pain-free, functioning body.

Every Wednesday 7PM-8PM

Orleton Village Hall

Contact: Ella Stanton-Warren

Number: 07968473955

Email: movewithella1@gmail.com

We need photographs for the
2027
ORLETON CALENDAR
with the theme "A Natural Place to be"



Please submit no more than three images
to Orleton Village Shop with your details
by the 3rd July 2026

The entries will be judged by a public
vote in the Village Hall on Sunday 5th July.

A very brief Ghost Story

Clutching his carrier bag the old man walked slowly through the churchyard to his wife's grave, as he had done every first Sunday in the month for the last five years. He knelt and with his hand fork loosened the sun-baked soil and pulled up the weeds that had grown since his last visit

As the churchyard was almost full, burials in the last few years had been inserted in the spaces between the older plots. His wife's grave was alongside a large rectangular Victorian monstrosity. As he worked, he heard the voice of a young woman coming from his left behind the tomb.

"Hello Lucy, I am Claire. John has asked me to marry him. I know that I can never compete with you. John still carries your photograph in his wallet. I may become old and grey but for John you will be forever young and beautiful."

"You will always be John's first love but he's such a good man I can live with that, and I have agreed to marry him. I hope you can understand Lucy."

After a period of silence, he heard a quiet "Goodbye".

The old man eventually finished his task and with creaking bones stood, gathered his kneeler, hand fork and small bag of weeds and made his way to the churchyard gate. As he passed the other side of the bulky Victorian tomb, he glanced down at another more modern burial of two years previous. The headstone read "Lucinda Elizabeth Morgan died aged Twenty-two"

Six months later the Church was packed with friends and relatives. Claire arrived accompanied by her two bridesmaids, friends from school who had been at her side all through her teens and early 20s, in night clubs and holidays in the sun

John was standing in front of the altar with his best man as Claire reached him and they both turned to face the congregation.

It was then that she realised that a third bridesmaid, who had been waiting in the shadows at the back of the church, had joined the wedding party. With horror she recognised the cascading chestnut hair from the photograph in John's wallet. John's face also showed the shock of recognition. However, the warmth of the beaming smile that greeted them drove out their fear which was replaced by a strange sense of calm and well-being. Even their wedding nerves disappeared, and their vows were word perfect

At the reception Bridesmaid Tracy questioned Claire about the third bridesmaid "We do not know her. Was she from John's side?" Claire responded "You could say that" with a strange smile.

Tracy's confusion was further compounded when the proofs of the wedding photographs arrived and only two bridesmaids gazed from the photos. Bridesmaid Beth asserted "She was standing right next to you Tracy, but she is not on the photos"

Some two years after the wedding friends and family gathered at the church again for the christening of Claire's and John's baby. The baby was christened Lucy Elizabeth

The Vicar questioned why there was only one godmother when normally a girl baby would have two. Claire responded that that would be two but one could not be there in person, but Claire knew that she would be there in spirit.

The group around the font did not notice the young woman with the chestnut hair standing quietly at the back of the Christening Party.

If you have a short story of less than 600 words, we would be please to publish it in Orleton Village Magazine. Who knows – it could be the start of an illustrious literary career!



Orleton Village

COME AND JOIN US FOR OUR

SUMMER FETE

SUNDAY 5th JULY

**Activities from
12noon to 4pm**



Dog Show – Stalls – Games
BBQ – Cakes – Ice cream – Bar – Cafe
Bouncy Castle – Hook a duck – Pets Corner
+ Village Calendar Photo Voting

CHILDREN'S WRISTBANDS - pay once
and play all afternoon in the children's area

Charity **Quiz** **Night**

TUESDAY 9TH JUNE
AT 8.00PM IN THE VILLAGE HALL

Hosted by **Dan Hurcomb**

TEAMS OF UP TO 6 PEOPLE * ENTRY £2 PLUS RAFFLE

Bring your own drinks and nibbles

- **Made things that you wish to sell?**
- **Grown plants that you have too many of?**
- **Spring cleaning or downsizing – need to dispose of things too good to throw away?**
- **Children's toys or games that they have out-grown?**
- **Sports equipment that you no longer use?**
- **Unwanted Christmas or birthday gifts?**
- **Bored with things- need to change your décor?**

All of these are good reasons to book a table at the Orleton Village Hall Table Top Sale.

The Sale will be held on Sunday 14th June, and a table will only cost £10.

Based on the demand at the previous sale we regret that we must restrict each seller to a maximum of two tables.

Only twenty two tables will be available.

Further details will be published nearer the event, but a seller may reserve a table(s) now, without cost, by simply sending their name and contact details to: bookings@orletonvillage.co.uk

Goods on sale must be capable of table top display (or stored under the table). The Village Hall Management regrets that to reasons of health and safety large items that take up floor space can not be accepted.

Orleton St George's Festival Report

On a wonderfully warm Sunday 26th April, Orleton once again celebrated the St George's Festival in style.

The festivities began at the Church, with a wonderful play put on by the people attending the Family Services, explaining the origin to the St George legend. In a twist to the usual ending, a reformed dragon lived to see another day. Jenny Pipes then took over with some brilliant Morris dancing in Church, before leading a parade to The Boot. Whereupon the adults took over with the usual highly entertaining Mummers' play, with St George slaying the dragon, and some more excellent Morris dancing,

including a dance version of the St George & the dragon story.

The fun continued with a maypole, and Marj's famous barbecue, and of course excellent refreshments from the bar at The Boot.

Hosted jointly by St George's Church, the Recreation Association and the Village Hall, this was a fun event that aimed to provide a bit of fun for people of all ages. We would like to thank The Boot very much for allowing the use of their lawn. Here's to next year!



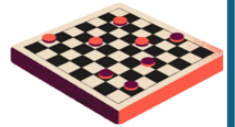
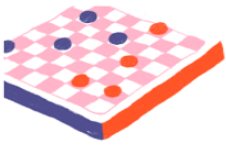
June Family Services

All in St George's Church

Join us for an informal, relaxed, interactive service involving craft or drama, followed by a light snack

Sunday 14th June, 3pm
(craft focused)

Sunday 28th June, 3pm
(drama focused)



PIZZA AND GAMES

FRIDAY 5 JUNE 6-8PM
THE MAIDENHEAD PUB

FRIDAY 3 JULY 6-8PM
ST GEORGE'S CHURCH

For all those who enjoy traditional family games, card games, newer strategy games, or all three

Orleton Footpath Maintenance Volunteers

Our keen bunch of volunteers have been out again making improvements to our community facilities here in Orleton and further afield

We've assessed the options for Red + White reflectors on the ford road bridges in Orleton's Millbrook Way, also by the Mill House by Captains Meadow...and given some suggestions as to how they might be reinstated

We've covered some hazardous barbed wire on footpath number OL3 next to footbridge off Millbrook Close with offcuts of some yellow gas polyethylene pipe.

Grant funding continues for the public footpath upgrades on the Comberton Trail - after a manufacturing delay of several months more galvanised pedestrian gates will be delivered (we hope) w/c 18th May.

Once the new gates have arrived Orleton Footpath Maintenance Volunteers will set about installing them. So too we'll install pedestrian gates on the Herefordshire Trail with grant funding from Herefordshire Ramblers.



At the end of April our volunteers installed a brand-new ditch footbridge plus a new handrail on the footpath from the B4362 Comberton towards Richards Castle just before Tudge's Farm. On the same stretch of footpath, we also reinforced three wooden stiles and improved

each of them by adding two steps and a handhold.



We've been involved with developing Grant Applications for Herefordshire Council Public Rights of Way Grants - this we've done for the Parish Councils of Orleton, Yarpole, Aymestrey, Elton, and Wigmore. We await to hear of success with these.

On OL9 we installed a galvanised pedestrian gate and repaired an existing galvanised metal gate.

We are helping refurbish the steep steps up a bank on the Mortimer Trail at Aymestrey
Saturday 16 May

In the coming months:

- On footpath OL7 'lost' footbridge - replacement of sixteen rotted treads, plus installing two galvanised pedestrian gates
- Three galvanised pedestrian gates to be installed on footpaths near Comberton.
- Landowner permission still to be sorted
- Sort some black touch up painting on Orleton village refurbished street signs
- Repairs to the bottom of the door of the red telephone box, then adding post office red paint to the repairs.

To get involved contact:
Martin Bradford 01586 780151

Three Musketeers, Aymestrey

All for One - and One for All!



This summer, Illyria Outdoor Theatre will be performing The Three Musketeers at Yatton Court, Aymestrey on Friday 31st July at 7pm.

Yatton Court is an 18th Century manor house and the performance, befitting the occasion, will take place in its grounds

Set against a sweeping panorama of 17th century France at war, the Three Musketeers is a whirlwind of excitement, comedy and ingenious storytelling. Romance! Intrigue! Murder! Betrayal! Revenge...! It's got the lot!

With a reputation for staging some of the finest swordplay in the business, Illyria's The Three Musketeers promises to be more dazzling than ever!

So, bring a picnic and a seat and immerse yourself in this electrifying experience. The proceeds will go to Aymestrey Church and Aymestrey Parish Hall.

The show will run for approximately 135 minutes, including a 20-minute interval and is recommended for ages 8+ as the Play contains scenes of peril, politics and passion! Younger children are welcome, if they're brave enough...

Bring your own seating/rug, suitable clothing & picnic. Only assistance dogs are permitted. Venue is wheelchair accessible by prior arrangement - email hello@alisonarcher.co.uk

Car parking is 200m from performance area.

The doors will open at 6pm and the performance starts at 7pm

To book your tickets visit: illyria.co.uk

Having a Garden Party?

Can't trust the weather?

Orleton Village Hall hires:

- **large easily erected marquee**
 - **Large trestle Tables**
 - **Plastic outdoor Chairs**

Contact: booking@orletonvillage.co.uk

Orleton Charity Quiz Nights

June 9th	Village Hall	November 16th	Village Hall
September 8th	Maidenhead	December 8th	Maidenhead
October 13th	Boot Inn		

All proceeds go to support local organisations in Orleton Village or recognised National Charities.

Special Event: John Robbins Memorial Quiz at Orleton Village Hall on a Saturday evening. Watch for the date!

**Teams of up to six members. 7.30 for a 8.00pm start
Pre-booking of tables at:
the Boot (01568 780228) and the Maidenhead (01584 831686)
is strongly advised**

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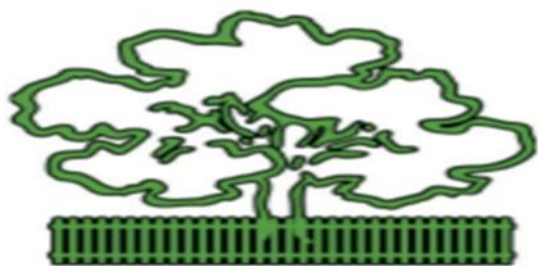
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Orleton and District
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OPEN CLASSES - Anyone can enter

Including: HEAVIEST MARROW COMPETITION - START SOWING NOW!

Who can ferment the best cider? Challenge your friends and neighbours.

OTHER OPEN CLASSES

Alcohol-based Cordial; Heaviest Potato; Longest Runner Bean; Most Amusing shaped Vegetable or Fruit JUST 10p PER ENTRY

Save the Date - Saturday 15th August - staging 10 - 11.30 am, viewing 1.30 -

3.30pm For more details and show rules see **SHOW SCHEDULE** at

www.orletongardeningclub.co.uk

Watch out? Here comes the bus!

In mid-May one of our Herefordshire farmer friends was contacted by a lady whose bus was held up by what she claimed to be some of his poultry chicks in the road. However, they were not his poultry but a group of pheasant chicks looking for their mother hen.

This incident prompted him to circulate the following email:

What the pheasant chicks were saying was "Mum, if one of those huge shiny things come along, do we get off the road?"

"Absolutely not! That is not the pheasant way. You stand your ground and stare it down, or

you run along the road in front of it to demonstrate who is in charge."

"But what happened to Uncle Silas? Isn't that his squished body back there?"

"Yes, because he wasn't bold enough. Didn't stand his ground like a proper pheasant."

Meanwhile, a lamb was listening to this conversation, "Mum, should I stare down the tractor when it comes?"

"No, no dear. You stick your head in the fence like a good lamb!"

This may not amuse a town-dweller, but the farming community will appreciate the rural humour.

Orleton History Group

On 30th May, the Orleton History Group was delighted to welcome Gisela Lehmann from the Leominster History Group. Her talk is yet to take place as I write but it promises to be fascinating, as she uses photographs to take us on a virtual tour of Leominster following the route she uses as a Leominster Heritage Guide for visitors to this historic town. A report will follow in the next edition of Grapevine.

Our upcoming talks and events are:
Saturday 27th June, 2.30pm, St George's Church, **The Poor Are Always With Us - the Parish and the Relief of Poverty**. James Turtle will explore this fascinating topic: For more than 300 years the people of Orleton paid an annual Poor Rate - a tax on land and houses to relieve poverty among its parishioners. What help did they get? Who ended up in the workhouse?

In July, we have a break for the summer as audiences are usually low due to the summer holidays.

Saturday 29th August, 2.30pm, St George's Church, topic TBC

You can read reports on previous talks at the history group page at:
www.stgeorgesorleton.org.uk
(and then click on 'Orleton History Group')

You can also find, at the same web address, the reports on the research undertaken so far into the lives of the men on the Orleton War Memorial.

If you would like further information about the group, please contact Liz Mackay on e.e.mackay@gmail.com, or 07484 679671.

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	Shop	Post Office
Mon- Fri	0745-1800	0745-1800
Sat	0830-1230	0830-1230
Sun	0830-1230	Closed

Whenever possible stock is sourced from local suppliers and below is a small selection;

- Tudge's bacon and sausages and hams (from Richard's Castle)
- Locally made cheeses, cakes and bread
- Variety of wines, beer and spirits
- Sweets, newspapers, magazines and local information
- Fresh fruit and vegetables
- Pet food
- Cards and stationery
- Amazon and Evri collection and drop-off
- Plants
- The shop also stocks all the household basics and a good range of Fairtrade and eco-friendly products.

Post office services include;

- Personal Banking
- Foreign Currency Exchange
- Pensions and Allowances and much more

Singing for Fun



Enjoy singing but want to just sing for fun? Why not join us at St George's 11am Friday mornings?

We sing old, well-known classics so no need to read music. All welcome, whether you want to hum, sing, or just listen.

Please just come along, or contact John Berry (jsberry47@gmail.com, 01568 782321) or Liz Mackay (e.e.mackay@gmail.com, or drop into Orleton shop)

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PROVIDER.



Orleton Good Neighbour Scheme

The Good Neighbour Scheme supports our community using a team of volunteers to help people who are experiencing difficulty in their own homes essentially, by just doing things that good neighbours do for each other.

Examples of how the scheme can help:

- Fetching prescriptions
- Occasional lifts to the surgery or hospital
- Shopping and running errands, such as posting a letter.
- Practical tasks around the home, such as changing a light bulb or hanging a picture

• **Contact Number 07467 535503**

Orleton Church & Chapel News (June 2026)

Update

In the Church calendar, May is a time of waiting – between Easter, when Jesus is crucified and rises from the dead; to Ascension, when Jesus disappears from his disciples' sight and leaves them to continue his ministry without his visible presence; to Pentecost when the disciples fully understand the meaning of the Holy Spirit – that Jesus is still with them in everything they do, in spirit, helping and guiding them as they try to live out his teachings. This is true for all of us.

So, it is, perhaps, appropriate that May has been a time for pausing and taking stock in both the Church's religious and social calendar, as we have reflected on excellent services over Easter and the wonderful St George's Festival (see article elsewhere in this newsletter), and prepared for some exciting Church services and social events in June.



In June, we continue with our usual pattern of Church services, both traditional morning services and more informal services in the afternoons, as detailed in the table below.

Social activities to look out for in June include:

- Pizza & Games evening, Friday 5th June, 6-8pm, St George's Church
- Flower Festival, Saturday & Sunday 6th & 7th June, 11am-5pm, St George's Church
- Ludlow Male Voice Choir, Friday 12th June, 7pm, St George's Church

More detail on all these events can be found in the adverts elsewhere in the magazine. Also, save the date for the Orleton Village Fete on 5th July.

Updates on our other activities, including an update on our Family Services, Prayer Group, the Orleton History Group, Singing for Fun, Open the Book, food bank donations, and the 100 Club winners, can be found in our full newsletter, at: <https://stgeorgesorleton.org.uk/news/news>, and click on 'Church & Chapel News'.

June 2026 Services & Times at St George's & Chapel

Date	Time	Location	Service	Readings
Sunday 7th June 1 st Sunday after Trinity	9.30am	St George's	BCP Holy Communion	Genesis 12.1-9 Romans 4.13-25 Matthew 9.9-13, 18-26
Sunday 14th June 2 nd Sunday after Trinity	10.30am	Chapel	Chapel Service, Ruth Downes, Holy Communion	Genesis 18.1-15 [21.1-7] Romans 5.1-8 Matthew 9.35 - 10.8 [9-23]
	3pm	St George's	Family Service, craft-focused	
Sunday 21st June 3 rd Sunday after Trinity	11am	St George's	Common Worship Holy Communion	Genesis 21.8-21 Romans 6.1b-11 Matthew 10.24-39
Sunday 28th June 4 th Sunday after Trinity	10.30am	Chapel	Chapel Service, Joyce Evans	Genesis 22.1-14 Romans 6.12-23 Matthew 10.40-42
	3pm	St George's	Family Service, drama-focused	

Further information

For further information about Church, Chapel, services or activities, or if you would like to get involved either socially or as a member of the congregation then please contact:

Matthew Burns (Vicar, St George's): 01568 614399, teamvicarwest@leominsterteam.org.uk

Rev Denise Hargreaves (Methodist Minister): 01584 318628, dkah26@gmail.com, Ludlow Church Office 01584 879233

Also, why not check out the St George's website: <https://stgeorgesorleton.org.uk/>



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Orleton Village Hall has regular weekly activities to which new members are always welcome. Contact details can be found here...

Monday's

- Orleton Toddlers** Every Monday morning 10-11:45am
Contact: Bethan 07534 726222 or Charlotte 07964 981036
- Orleton WI** 2nd Monday of the month, October to March at 2:30pm
Contact: Sue Copson susancopson934@gmail.com

Tuesday's

- Rainbows** Every Tuesday in term time 4:30-5:30pm
Contact Kaye Harrison kayemharrison@yahoo.co.uk
- Orleton Ramblers** 2nd and 4th Tuesday of month - Meet at Village Hall 9:50am, leaving at 10:00am
Contact: Jan Greatrex tandjgreatrex@gmail.com
- Gardening Club** Last Tuesday of the month 7:30-9:30pm
Contact: Monica 01568 613861 orletongc@hotmail.co.uk
- Yoga** Every Tuesday evening 6:30-7:30pm (Commences again in September)
Contact Rosie 07834 851656

Wednesday's

- Coffee Morning** Every Wednesday at 10:30am-12:00 (Closed in August)
Contact: Cathy Hardwick cathy.hardwick@hotmail.co.uk
- Library** Last Wednesday of the month at Coffee Morning 10:30-11:45am
Contact: Sue Rogers 01584 831514
- Sequence Dancing** 3rd Wednesday of the month – 2-3pm
Contact: Amy Whitby amyelwynwhitby@gmail.com

Thursday's

- Evergreens** Last Thursday of the month – 2-4pm
Contact: Sue Turner sue.a.turner@gmail.com
- Craft Group** 1st and 3rd Thursday of each month 1:30-4:30pm (No sessions in August)
Contact Sue Turner 01584 831324 sue.a.turner@gmail.com
- Table Tennis** Every Thursday at 7:30pm
Contact: Geoff Lewin geoffnlewin@gmail.com

Orleton Village Hall is available for private bookings
Contact Barry Gandy 01568 780583 or bookings@orletonvillage.co.uk

All entries are, as far as we know, correct at the time of going to print.

Contacts

Allotments Assoc	Nick Ford		01584 875834
Art Group	Geoff Trotter	Geoffrey.a.trotter@gmail.com	
Caring for God' Little Acre	Barbara Mark		01568 780842
Church Wardens	Liz Mackay		07484 679671
	John Berry		01568 780321
Doctors			01584 831300
Evergreens	Sue Turner	sue.a.turner@gmail.com	01584 831324
Gardening Club	Nick Russel		01568 780678
Good Neighbour Scheme			07467 535503
Herefordshire Councillor	Cllr. Dan Hurcomb	dan.hurcomb@herefordshire.gov.uk	07792 882147
Land Drainage Group	David Lane		01568 78036
Orleton Footpath Maintenance Volunteers	Matin Bradford	emimart@hotmail.com	01568780151
Orleton Relief in Need	Barry Rogers		01584 831514
Orleton Junior Football Club	Mel Williams	cherry.brook@me.com	07511 920515
Orleton Toddlers	Bethan Jenkins	Bethan.l.edwards@hotmail.co.uk	07534 726222
Orleton Young Farmers Club	Bell Beaumont	orleyonyfc@hotmail.com	
Parish Council		clerk@orleton-pc.gov.uk	
Pre-School	Tara Morris		01568 780143
Primary School		admin@orleton.hereford.sch.uk	01568 780366
Primary School PTA	Nicola Goodman	nicolagoodman1989@gmail.com	
Rainbows	Carly Morgan		07788 236628
Recreation Association	Graham Shaw		01568 780783
Village Hall		bookings@orletonvillage.co.uk	01568 780583
WI	Sue Copson		01568 780956